

2. REQUIREMENT ANALYSIS PHASE

2.1 Introduction

The Requirement Analysis phase identifies the functional and non-functional requirements required to implement the Incident Lifecycle Management solution in ServiceNow.

The requirements are derived from the activities that a Service Desk agent and technical support team perform while handling an incident.

2.2 Stakeholders

End User / Caller

The end user reports an issue or service interruption and provides the necessary information regarding the problem.

Service Desk Agent

The Service Desk Agent creates the incident, verifies the information, classifies the incident, performs initial investigation, communicates with the user, and resolves simple incidents.

Level 2 Support Team

The Level 2 Support Team handles incidents requiring deeper technical investigation and expertise.

Assignment Group

The assignment group is responsible for investigating and resolving incidents assigned to a particular technical area.

Change Management Team

The Change Management Team handles changes required to resolve incidents, including emergency changes.

Knowledge Management Team

The Knowledge Management Team maintains reusable solutions and knowledge articles.

ServiceNow Administrator

The administrator configures users, groups, services, workflows, permissions, SLAs, and other required ServiceNow components.

2.3 Functional Requirements

FR1 – Service/Service Offering Creation

The system should allow the required service or service offering to be created and made available for incident management.

FR2 – Incident Creation

The Service Desk Agent should be able to create a new incident.

The incident should contain important information such as:

- Caller
- Short description
- Description
- Service
- Service offering
- Category
- Subcategory
- Configuration Item
- Impact
- Urgency
- Priority
- Assignment group
- Assigned to
- State

FR3 – Incident Classification

The system should support the classification of incidents based on their nature and business impact.

The classification should include:

- Category
- Subcategory
- Impact
- Urgency

- Priority

Correct classification helps ensure that critical incidents receive appropriate attention.

FR4 – Incident Assignment

The incident should be assigned to the appropriate support group based on the type of issue.

The assigned support team should be able to investigate and update the incident.

FR5 – Incident Escalation

When an incident cannot be resolved by the initial Service Desk team, it should be escalated to the appropriate **Level 2 support team**.

All investigation details should remain available during escalation.

FR6 – Knowledge Integration

Support agents should be able to search for relevant knowledge articles while investigating an incident.

If an appropriate solution already exists, the agent can use the knowledge article to resolve the incident more quickly.

FR7 – Emergency Change Request

If resolving an incident requires an urgent change to the IT environment, an emergency change request should be created and associated with the incident.

This provides traceability between the incident and the change performed to resolve it.

FR8 – Child Incident Creation

The system should support the creation of child incidents when multiple incidents are associated with a common parent issue.

The relationship between parent and child incidents should be maintained.

FR9 – Incident Resolution

Once the issue is fixed, the support agent should update the incident with appropriate resolution information.

The resolution information should include:

- Resolution code
- Resolution notes
- Fix details
- Relevant comments

FR10 – Knowledge Creation

If the solution to an incident can be useful for future incidents, a knowledge article should be created.

The article should describe the problem, cause, and resolution steps.

FR11 – SLA Tracking

The system should track the applicable SLA for the incident.

Support teams should be able to verify whether the incident is:

- Within SLA
- Approaching SLA breach
- Breached

FR12 – Related Record Validation

The system should maintain and display relationships between the incident and other records such as:

- Child incidents
- Change requests
- Knowledge articles
- SLA records

2.4 Non-Functional Requirements

Usability

The system should provide an easy-to-use interface for creating, updating, and tracking incidents.

Performance

Incident records and related information should be retrieved without unnecessary delays.

Security

Only authorized users should be able to view or modify incident, change, and knowledge information according to their roles.

Reliability

Incident information should be stored reliably without loss of data.

Scalability

The system should support an increasing number of incidents and users.

Maintainability

ServiceNow administrators should be able to modify configurations and workflows when business requirements change.

Auditability

Important changes to incident records should be traceable through activity history.

2.5 Requirement Analysis Outcome

After requirement analysis, the major modules required for the solution are identified as:

Incident Management, Service Management, Assignment Management, Knowledge Management, Change Management, SLA Management, and Related Record Management.